

Atonement



A lamb stands in the open and looks at you. Unblemished, alive, and — if you know the story — appointed to die. The softness is not the message. The innocence is.

Before you gather

- Read Day 13, Atonement, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Exodus 12:5–7, 12–13 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.

- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

Have you ever paid for something someone else broke?

Leader. A cost moved from the guilty to someone else. Then open Exodus 12. The lamb dies. The people live. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: Atonement means Jesus, the substitute, died for sinners. His blood covers us. This was the plan, not an accident.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Atonement is the once-for-all work of Christ in His life and sacrificial death in which He, as our substitute, bore the penalty of sin, satisfied God's wrath, fulfilled the demands of divine justice, and reconciled sinners to God, securing redemption for all who believe.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Hebrew *kapar* — to cover, to purge, to make atonement.

MEMORY VERSE · 1 PETER 2:24

He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we might die to sin and live to righteousness. By his wounds you have been healed.

Together, open the flashcard for Atonement. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Exodus 12:5–7, 12–13

1 Peter 2:24 is the memory verse. Stay in the Passover. The blood on the door is how judgment passed over. Do not skip to a general talk about kindness.

Your lamb shall be without blemish, a male a year old. You may take it from the sheep or from the goats, and you shall keep it until the fourteenth day of this month, when the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill their lambs at twilight. Then they shall take some of the blood and put it on the two doorposts and the lintel of the houses in which they eat it. The blood shall be a sign for you, on the houses where you are. And when I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will befall you to destroy you, when I strike the land of Egypt.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. What kind of lamb does Exodus 12 require, and what is done with its blood? CORE

Leader. A lamb without blemish. The blood is put on the doorposts. God says, “When I see the blood, I will pass over you.” The blood, not their goodness, is why death passes over.

2. Who eats the meal, and who is spared? What does that say about a sacrifice no one trusts?

Leader. The household under the blood eats and is spared. A lamb ignored does not cover the house. Do not say the cross saves people who refuse Christ.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. 1 Peter 2:24 says He bore our sins in His body on the tree. Who is the substitute, and whose sins are borne?

Leader. Christ bears the sins of His people in His body. We do not bear them ourselves if we are in Him. He was our substitute.

4. John 1:29: "Behold, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world." How does Passover help you say that to a neighbor? **CORE**

Leader. The lamb dies so the guilty live. Jesus is that Lamb. Practice the sentence. Do not turn it into "be a better person."

5. Hebrews 9:22 says without the shedding of blood there is no forgiveness. Why can a sincere apology not replace the cross?

Leader. Sin is against God. He requires blood. Jesus came to die. Our apology does not atone.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Atonement is Jesus, our substitute, covering sin by His blood so we can be brought back to God.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Pay a real cost for someone far from Jesus — a meal, a bill, a mess you did not make. Tell them Jesus died as our substitute, and your payment is only a shadow.

Leader. Do the thing and say the sentence. Do not make them perform gratitude. Do not say everyone is already covered apart from faith. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Father, thank You for the blood that causes judgment to pass over.
2. Forgive us for trusting our record instead of the Lamb.
3. Send us to speak of the Lamb of God this week.

Before you stumble

Do not say the cross automatically saved every person whether they believe or not. The Passover covered the house under the blood. Also do not shrink the Lamb to a moral example. He died for sins. Correct both errors.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask why the lamb had to be without blemish. Then ask who in the room is without blemish. The answer is Jesus, not them.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Isaiah 53:5–6. He was pierced for our transgressions. Read it if you have three minutes. He was our substitute.